On the consequences of the lack of value statement

> Let's look at a real-life example. A data scientist proposes a communication test to improve customer understanding: nothing fancy, just A/B testing composed of two messages. The business manager responsible for this communication channel shoots the idea down, asking, "Will performing this test immediately improve my direct KPIs?"
>
> The data scientist cannot convince that manager to send two types of messages, with one likely to perform worse than the other. He is instead expected to come back with just the better ones, but with no testing!
>
> A clear data-related value statement justifying a locally suboptimal action that promises better future performance would be of great help.

You may find a definition indicating that a value statement is supposed to show what the company "believes in." However, it is hard to imagine what "the company" believes. So instead, think of a value statement as a list of the company's highest priorities.

In chapter 3, we presented a general value statement structure, as provided by Robert S. Seiner in *Non-Invasive Data Governance* :

> Organizations that [take some action], demonstrate [business value improvement].

In practice, this means that if you plan to take an action directly related to a value statement, you should be able to end any discussion undermining the necessity of this action by using the following argument:

> We should take this *action*, because according to our value statement, it will bring this *benefit*.

This is, of course, the ultimate argument for the need to take an action. It cannot end the discussion on, for example, a timeline or a budget for such an action.

It is worth remembering that data value statements will be based on the company strategy. So, for example, the statement "Organizations transparently sharing data with the world are perceived as trustworthy" may